

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent Application Publication

20250277866

Kind Code

A1

Publication Date

September 04, 2025

Inventor(s)

Sung; Jin Su et al.

Battery Management System, Battery Pack Comprising Same, and Method of Diagnosing Deterioration of Secondary Battery

Abstract

A battery management system for diagnosing the degradation of secondary batteries equipped with a positive electrode including lithium iron phosphate as a positive electrode active material is provided. The battery management system includes a sensing part configured to measure the voltage and open circuit voltage of a secondary battery; a memory part configured to store the open circuit voltage measured by the sensing part; and a control part configured to determine that the secondary battery is degraded if the amount of change in the open circuit voltage due to charge/discharge cycles of the secondary battery, for at least five charge/discharge cycles, satisfies the following condition: $V_{sub.n-1} - V_{sub.n} < 0.002V$, (where $V_{sub.n-1}$ represents the open circuit voltage measured during the $(n-1)$.sup.th charge-discharge cycle, $V_{sub.n}$ represents the open circuit voltage measured during the n .sup.th charge/discharge cycle, and n is an integer.)

Inventors: Sung; Jin Su (Daejeon, KR), Kim; Ki Woong (Daejeon, KR), An; In Gu (Daejeon, KR), Kwon; O Jong (Daejeon, KR), Choi; Jung Hun (Daejeon, KR), Kim; Kwang Jin (Daejeon, KR), Lee; Da Young (Daejeon, KR), Park; Jeong Hwa (Daejeon, KR), Han; Geum Jae (Daejeon, KR)

Applicant: LG Energy Solution, Ltd. (Seoul, KR)

Family ID: 91033212

Assignee: LG Energy Solution, Ltd. (Seoul, KR)

Appl. No.: 18/855756

Filed (or PCT Filed): November 09, 2023

PCT No.: PCT/KR2023/018007

Foreign Application Priority Data

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: **G01R31/392** (20190101); **G01R31/3835** (20190101); **H01M4/02** (20060101); **H01M4/58** (20100101); **H01M4/587** (20100101); **H02J7/00** (20060101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC **G01R31/392** (20190101); **G01R31/3835** (20190101); **H01M4/5825** (20130101); **H01M4/587** (20130101); **H02J7/005** (20200101); **H02J7/007182** (20200101); **H01M2004/027** (20130101); **H01M2004/028** (20130101)

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS [0001] The present application is a 371 National Stage entry of PCT/KR2023/018007 filed Nov. 9, 2023, which claims the benefit of foreign priority based on Korean Patent Application No 10-2022-0150244, filed on Nov. 11, 2022, the disclosures of which are incorporated by reference herein.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] The present disclosure relates to a battery management system for diagnosing the degradation of secondary batteries equipped with a positive electrode including lithium iron phosphate, a battery pack including the same, and a method for diagnosing the degradation of secondary batteries.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Recently, with the rapidly increasing demand for portable electronics such as laptops, video cameras, and portable phones, as well as the development of electric vehicles, energy storage batteries, robots, and satellites, research on high-performance batteries that can be repeatedly charged and discharged has been ongoing.

[0004] Currently, commercially available

[0005] batteries include nickel-cadmium batteries, nickel-hydrogen batteries, nickel-zinc batteries, and lithium secondary batteries, which have been gaining attention for their ability to charge and discharge freely with little memory effect, very low self-discharge rate, and high energy density compared to nickel-based batteries.

[0006] As these lithium secondary batteries are repeatedly charged and discharged, they undergo degradation, which is a reduction in capacity and energy. As the battery degrades, its cycling performance, such as capacity retention rate, decreases, reducing the lifespan of the battery and decreasing its usability. Therefore, it is necessary to diagnose whether the secondary battery in use is degraded or not, and to repair the battery if it is diagnosed as degraded.

[0007] Various techniques exist for diagnosing the state of degradation of a battery. For example, the following patent discloses utilizing Differential Voltage Analysis (“DVA”) to obtain information about a degradation state of a battery from the Q-dV/dQ curve of the battery. The Q-dV/dQ curve can be represented as a graph with a Q-axis and a dV/dQ-axis, where Q is the amount of storage, V is the voltage, dV is the amount of change in V over a predetermined time, dQ is the amount of change in Q over the predetermined time, and dV/dQ is the ratio of dV to dQ.

[0008] However, these techniques are not suitable for determining the degradation of a secondary battery having a positive electrode with lithium iron phosphate as the positive electrode active material. FIG. 1 is a graph illustrating the voltage according to the capacity of a secondary battery

having a positive electrode with lithium iron phosphate as the positive electrode active material. Referring to FIG. 1, it can be seen that due to the structural features of lithium iron phosphate, a secondary battery including lithium iron phosphate as the positive electrode active material exhibits a flat voltage even the charge and discharge capacity varies. This phenomenon is due to the stability of the olivine structure of lithium phosphate and the similarity of the crystal structures of LiFePO_4 in the discharged state and FePO_4 in the charged state. Therefore, it is not possible to determine whether or not the secondary battery including lithium phosphate as the positive electrode active material is degraded or the degree of degradation based on the differential voltage analysis method, so it is necessary to develop a technology for this.

SUMMARY

Technical Problem

[0009] The present disclosure aims to provide a battery management system and method for diagnosing the degradation due to repeated charging and discharging in a secondary battery including lithium iron phosphate as a positive electrode active material, as well as a battery pack including the same.

Technical Solution

[0010] The present disclosure provides a battery management system for diagnosing the degradation of secondary batteries equipped with a positive electrode including lithium iron phosphate as a positive electrode active material, including: a sensing part configured to measure the voltage and open circuit voltage of a secondary battery; a memory part configured to store the open circuit voltage measured by the sensing part; and a control part configured to determine that the secondary battery is degraded if the amount of change in the open circuit voltage due to charge/discharge cycles of the secondary battery satisfies Condition 1 below for at least five charge/discharge cycles.

[00001] $V_{n-1} - V_n < 0.002V$ [Condition1]

[0011] (In Condition 1, V_{n-1} represents the open circuit voltage measured during the $(n-1)$.sup.th charge-discharge cycle, V_n represents the open circuit voltage measured during the n.sup.th charge/discharge cycle, and n represents a random integer)

[0012] In an exemplary aspect of the present disclosure, the sensing part may be configured to measure the voltage of the secondary battery during discharge, and to measure the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery each time the measured voltage reaches a reference discharge voltage.

[0013] In an exemplary aspect of the present disclosure, the sensing part may be configured to measure the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery during the rest period after reaching the reference discharge voltage.

[0014] In an exemplary aspect of the present disclosure, the sensing part may be configured to measure the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery at the end of each charge/discharge cycle.

[0015] A battery management system according to another exemplary aspect of the present disclosure may further include a switching part that turns the electrical connection between the secondary battery and the charger on and off.

[0016] The present disclosure provides a battery pack including: the battery management system and a plurality of secondary batteries.

[0017] In an exemplary aspect of the present disclosure, the secondary battery may include a graphite-based negative electrode active material as the negative electrode active material, comprising 50 to 100% by weight of the total weight of the negative electrode active material included in the negative electrode.

[0018] A method for diagnosing the degradation of a secondary battery according to the present disclosure is a method for diagnosing the degradation of a secondary battery equipped with a positive electrode including lithium iron phosphate as a positive electrode active material, including: (A) a process of repeatedly charging and discharging a secondary battery, while

measuring the voltage when the secondary battery discharges and measuring the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery whenever the measured voltage reaches a reference discharge voltage; and (B) a process of determining that a secondary battery is degraded when the change in open circuit voltage satisfies Condition 1 below for at least five charge/discharge cycles.

[00002] $V_{n-1} - V_n < 0.002V$ [Condition1]

[0019] (In Condition 1, V_{n-1} represents the open circuit voltage measured during the (n-1).sup.th charge-discharge cycle, V_n represents the open circuit voltage measured during the n.sup.th charge/discharge cycle, and n represents a random integer)

[0020] In an exemplary aspect of the present disclosure, the process (A) may include measuring the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery during the rest period after reaching the reference discharge voltage.

[0021] In an exemplary aspect of the present disclosure, the process (A) may include measuring the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery at the end of each charge/discharge cycle.

Advantageous Effects

[0022] In a secondary battery equipped with a positive electrode including lithium iron phosphate as the positive electrode active material, by using the characteristic that the potential difference of the negative electrode is showed as the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery, there is an effect of diagnosing the degradation of the secondary battery from the amount of change in the open circuit voltage as the charge/discharge cycle progresses.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0023] FIG. 1 is a graph illustrating the voltage according to the capacity for a secondary battery having a positive electrode with lithium iron phosphate as a positive electrode active material.

[0024] FIG. 2 is a diagram illustrating an exemplary configuration of a battery pack including a battery management system according to an exemplary aspect of the present disclosure.

[0025] FIG. 3 is a block diagram schematically illustrating a battery management system according to an exemplary aspect of the present disclosure.

[0026] FIG. 4 is a graph illustrating an exemplary measurement of open circuit voltage over a charge/discharge cycle calculated by a battery management system **100** according to an exemplary aspect of the present disclosure.

[0027] FIG. 5 is a schematic diagram of a battery pack including a battery management system according to another exemplary aspect of the present disclosure.

[0028] FIG. 6 is a flowchart illustrating an exemplary method for diagnosing degradation of a secondary battery according to another exemplary aspect of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0029] Reference numerals used in the present disclosure are as follows: [0030] **1**: ELECTRICAL SYSTEM [0031] **2**: UPPER-LEVEL CONTROLLER [0032] **10**: BATTERY MODULE [0033] **11**: SECONDARY BATTERY [0034] **1000**, **2000**: BATTERY PACK [0035] **100**, **200**: BATTERY MANAGEMENT SYSTEM [0036] **110**, **210**: SENSING PART [0037] **120**, **220**: MEMORY PART [0038] **130**, **230**: CONTROL PART [0039] **240**: SWITCHING PART [0040] **250**: INTERFACE PART

[0041] Hereinafter, the preferred aspects of the present disclosure will be described in detail with reference to the attached drawings. Prior to this, the terms and words used in this specification and claims should not be construed in a limited or merely dictionary sense, but should be interpreted according to the meaning and concept consistent with the technical spirit of the present disclosure, based on the principle that the inventor is entitled to define terms in a way that best describes his disclosure.

[0042] Therefore, it should be understood that the aspects described in this specification and the configurations illustrated in the drawings are merely the most preferred aspects of the present disclosure and do not represent all the technical spirit of the present disclosure, so it should be understood that various equivalents and modifications that could substitute for these aspects may exist at the time of filing this application.

[0043] Throughout the specification, when a part is said to “include” a component, it is meant to be inclusive of other components, not exclusive of other components, unless specifically noted to the contrary. Also, terms such as <control unit> in the specification mean a unit that handles at least one function or operation, which may be implemented in hardware, software, or a combination of hardware and software.

[0044] Furthermore, throughout the specification, when a part is said to be “connected” to another part, this includes not only when it is “directly connected” but also when it is “indirectly connected” with another element in between.

[0045] FIG. 2 is a diagram of an exemplary configuration of a battery pack including a battery management system according to an exemplary aspect of the present disclosure.

[0046] Referring to FIG. 2, the battery pack **1000** may be provided for installation in an electrical system (e.g., an electric vehicle). The battery management system **100** according to the present disclosure may be electrically connected to the battery module **10**, which includes a plurality of secondary batteries **11**, to diagnose the condition of each of the plurality of secondary batteries.

[0047] Furthermore, the battery management system **100** according to the present disclosure may be included in the battery pack **1000** together with the battery module **10**. While FIG. 2 illustrates an example in which the battery pack **1000** includes one battery module **10** and one battery management system **100**, the number of battery modules **10** and battery management systems **100** included in the battery pack **1000** is not limited to the number shown in FIG. 2. Similarly, the number of secondary batteries **11** included in the battery module **10** is not limited to the number shown in FIG. 2.

[0048] A battery module and a secondary battery included in a battery pack of the present disclosure are described. A secondary battery subject to degradation diagnosis by the battery management system **100** of the present disclosure includes lithium iron phosphate as the positive electrode active material of the positive electrode.

[0049] A lithium secondary battery with lithium iron phosphate as a positive electrode active material includes a plateau interval in which, in a capacity-voltage graph corresponding to voltage as a function of capacity, the amount of change in voltage is zero or close to zero in a certain capacity interval, despite a change in capacity according to charge and discharge. In the prior art, there is no way to diagnose degradation of a secondary battery applied with lithium iron phosphate. The present disclosure provides a battery management system and a battery pack including the system that can diagnose the degradation of such a secondary battery.

[0050] In exemplary aspects, the lithium iron phosphate may be a compound of the Chemical
[0051] Formula 1 below.

$\text{Li.sub.1+aFe.sub.1-xM.sub.x(PO.sub.4-b)X.sub.b}$ [Chemical Formula 1]

[0052] In Chemical Formula 1, M includes one or more elements selected from the group consisting of Al, Mg, Ni, Co, Mn, Ti, Ga, Cu, V, Nb, Zr, Ce, In, Zn, and Y, and X includes one or more elements selected from the group consisting of F, S, and N, and a, b, and x are $-0.5 \leq a \leq 0.5$, $0 \leq b \leq 0.1$, and $0 \leq x \leq 0.5$, respectively)

[0053] For example, the lithium iron phosphate may be LiFePO.sub.4 .

[0054] In exemplary aspects, the negative electrode comprising the secondary battery of the present disclosure may include a graphite-based negative electrode active material as the negative electrode active material, and more specifically, the graphite-based negative electrode active material may be included in an amount of 50 wt % to 100 wt % with respect to the total weight of the negative

electrode active material. In response to a change in the state of charge or depth of discharge, the graphite-based negative electrode active material changes the potential of the negative electrode. In other words, in the case of a negative electrode including a graphite-based negative electrode active material, the correlation graph between the State Of Charge (SOC) or Depth of Discharge (DOD) and the negative electrode potential does not include a plateau interval where the negative electrode potential does not change in response to a change in the state of charge or depth of discharge, and therefore, a secondary battery having a negative electrode including a graphite-based negative electrode active material is suitable for application of the degeneration diagnosis method of the present disclosure.

[0055] Specific examples of such graphite-based negative electrode active materials include synthetic graphite, natural graphite, graphitized carbon fiber, amorphous carbon, carbonaceous materials such as low-crystalline carbon and high-crystalline carbon, and composites including metallic compounds and carbonaceous materials. Low-crystalline carbons include soft carbon and hard carbon, and high-crystalline carbons include natural graphite, kish graphite, and pyrolytic carbon, mesophase pitch based carbon fiber, meso-carbon microbeads, mesophase pitches, and high temperature calcined carbons such as petroleum or coal tar pitch derived cokes.

[0056] A specific configuration of the battery management system **100** will be described with reference to FIG. 3. FIG. 3 is a block diagram schematically illustrating a battery management system according to an exemplary aspect of the present disclosure.

[0057] Referring to FIG. 3, the battery management system **100** may include a sensing part **110**, a memory part **120**, and a control part **130**.

[0058] The sensing part **110** may be configured to measure a voltage of the secondary battery **11** included in the battery module **10**. That is, the sensing part **110** may be configured to measure a voltage of each of the secondary batteries **11** included in the battery module **10**.

[0059] For example, in the aspect illustrated in FIG. 2, the sensing part **110** can measure a voltage when the first secondary battery C1, the second secondary battery C2, the third secondary battery C3, and the fourth secondary battery C4 included in the battery module **10** are discharged, respectively. Specifically, the sensing part **110** may measure the voltage of the first secondary battery C1 through the first sensing line SL1 and the second sensing line SL2, and the voltage of the second secondary battery C2 through the second sensing line SL2 and the third sensing line SL3. Further, the sensing part **110** may measure the voltage of the third secondary battery C3 through the third sensing line SL3 and the fourth sensing line SL4, and may measure the voltage of the fourth secondary battery C4 through the fourth sensing line SL4 and the fifth sensing line SL5.

[0060] Further, the sensing part **110** is configured to measure the open circuit voltage (OCV) of the secondary battery **11**. That is, the sensing part **110** is configured to measure both the voltage of the secondary battery **11** and the open circuit voltage. Further, the sensing part **110** is configured to measure the voltage of the secondary battery when the secondary battery is charged and discharged, and is configured to measure the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery **11** for determining degradation.

[0061] The secondary battery undergoes degradation with repeated charge/discharge cycles, and the sensing part **110** may be configured to measure the voltage of the secondary battery while the secondary battery **11** is being charged and discharged, and to measure the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery **11** at the end of each charge/discharge cycle for data collection for diagnosing degradation. One charge/discharge cycle may be defined as the process of charging the secondary battery **11** in a discharged state and then discharging the secondary battery **11** in a charged state.

[0062] The sensing part **110** can measure the open circuit voltage of each secondary battery **11** whenever the voltage of the secondary battery being measured reaches a reference discharge voltage during N (N is an integer greater than or equal to 2) charge/discharge cycles for the secondary battery. Here, the reference discharge voltage may be a voltage preset and stored by a

user or the like to enable the sensing part **110** to measure the open circuit voltage. In other words, the reference discharge voltage is a reference value for the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery **11** to be measured by the sensing part **110**, and may provide a period when the sensing part **110** should measure the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery **11**. For example, the reference discharge voltage may be 2.5V. However, it is not limited to this.

[0063] The sensing part **110** may be configured to measure the voltage of a plurality of secondary batteries **11** as they discharge, and to measure the open circuit voltage of a corresponding secondary battery **11** whenever the measured voltage of the secondary battery **11** reaches the reference discharge voltage. The sensing part **110** may be configured to measure the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery **11** during rest, after the secondary battery **11** has reached the reference discharge voltage. By resting, it means a period of time after the secondary battery has finished discharging, during which it waits for a period of time before charging for the next charge/discharge cycle. As a non-limiting example, the open circuit voltage may be measured within 1 second after the end of the discharge, more specifically within 1 minute after 3 seconds, and more specifically within 30 seconds after 5 seconds.

[0064] For example, in the aspect shown in FIG. 2, it is assumed that a reference discharge voltage is set to $V_s[V]$ for each of the secondary batteries **11**. At this time, the sensing part **110** can measure the open circuit voltage of the first secondary battery **C1** when the voltage of the first secondary battery **C1** reaches V_s by discharging. Similarly, when the respective voltage of the second secondary battery **C2**, the third secondary battery **C3**, and the fourth secondary battery **C4** reaches V_s , the sensing part **110** can measure the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery that has reached V_s .

[0065] In one particular example, the sensing part **110** may include a voltage sensor (not shown). The voltage sensor is electrically connected to a positive terminal and a negative terminal of the secondary battery **11**. The voltage sensor may be installed in the charge and discharge path of the secondary battery. In addition, the sensing part **110** may further include a current sensor (not shown). The current sensor may be configured to measure the current in the secondary battery at predetermined times while the secondary battery is being charged or discharged.

[0066] The memory part **120** may be operably coupled to the sensing part **110**. The memory part **120** may be configured to store open circuit voltage measurements taken by the sensing part **110**, as well as other sensing information. The memory part **120** may also store data or programs required for each component of the battery management system **100** to perform operations and functions, or data generated in the course of performing operations and functions.

[0067] The memory part **120** may be configured to store the measured open circuit voltage of the secondary battery **11** at the end of each charge/discharge cycle, while repeating the charge/discharge. In one example, the memory part **120** may be configured to store the measured open-circuit voltage value for the secondary battery **11** at the end of each charge/discharge cycle, such as storing the measured open-circuit voltage V_1 when the reference discharge voltage is reached in the discharge process of the first charge/discharge cycle, storing the measured open-circuit voltage V_2 when the reference discharge voltage is reached in the discharge process of the second charge/discharge cycle, and so on.

[0068] The memory part **120** is not particularly limited in type as long as it is a means for storing information of a publication known to be capable of recording, erasing, and updating data. In one example, the memory part **120** may include one or more type of storage medium selected from the group consisting of a flash memory type, a hard disk type, a solid state disk type, a silicon disk drive type, a multimedia card micro type, random access memory (RAM), a static random access memory (SRAM), a read-only memory (ROM), an electrically erasable programmable read-only memory (EEPROM), and a programmable read-only memory (PROM).

[0069] The control part **130** may receive the open circuit voltage measured by the sensing part **110**. The control part **130** may be configured to communicate electrical signals to and from the memory

part **120** within the battery management system **100** to receive open circuit voltage data stored in the memory part **120** based on charge/discharge cycles.

[0070] The control part **130** may be configured to calculate, from the memory part **120**, an amount of change in each open circuit voltage measured over a charge/discharge cycle, and may be configured to determine that the secondary battery is degraded if the amount of change in the open circuit voltage due to charge/discharge cycles of the secondary battery satisfies Condition 1 below for at least five charge/discharge cycles.

[00003] $V_{n-1} - V_n < 0.002V$ [Condition1]

[0071] (In Condition 1, V_{n-1} represents the open circuit voltage measured during the (n-1).sup.th charge-discharge cycle, V_n represents the open circuit voltage measured during the n.sup.th charge/discharge cycle, and n represents a random integer)

[0072] That is, the control part **130** determines whether the amount of change in the open circuit voltage V_{n-1} measured in the previous charge/discharge cycle and the open circuit voltage V_n measured in the current charge/discharge cycle is less than 0.002 V, and if the amount of change in such open circuit voltage satisfies Condition 1 for at least five charge/discharge cycles, the corresponding secondary battery may be determined to have degraded.

[0073] FIG. 4 is a graph illustrating an exemplary measurement of an open circuit voltage over a charge/discharge cycle calculated by the battery management system **100** according to an exemplary aspect of the present disclosure. The control part **130** may generate the graph shown in FIG. 4 from open circuit voltage data stored in the memory part **120**. The graph in FIG. 4 shows a relationship between the cycle number and the open circuit voltage, wherein the open circuit voltage gradually decreases as the charge/discharge cycle progresses, and the amount of change in the voltage gradually becomes smaller and smaller, and the amount of change in the open circuit voltage approaches zero after about 1500 cycles.

[0074] Compared to spinel or layered positive electrode active materials, the Olivine structure of lithium phosphate is stable to structural changes due to degradation or deterioration, and as a result, the voltage of lithium phosphate does not change significantly with charge and discharge.

Therefore, in a secondary battery with a positive electrode including lithium phosphate, the voltage of the secondary battery is often determined by the potential difference of the negative electrode. In other words, the measured open circuit voltage of a lithium phosphate-based secondary battery is easy to determine the potential difference of the negative electrode.

[0075] Accordingly, in order to diagnose the degradation of a secondary battery having a lithium iron phosphate positive electrode, if the amount of change in the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery measured in the resting phase after discharge during the progress of a charge/discharge cycle is less than 0.002V for a certain cycle, the negative electrode is considered to be degraded, and the degradation of the secondary battery can be determined.

[0076] In a lithium secondary battery having a positive electrode with lithium iron phosphate as the positive electrode active material, as charge/discharge cycles are accumulated, due to the difference in charge and discharge rates of the positive electrode and negative electrode, lithium may be charged on a non-facing part of the negative electrode that is not facing the positive electrode. The non-facing part of the negative electrode that is not facing the positive electrode exists because the negative electrode is cut larger than the positive electrode, and typically the edge part of the negative electrode becomes the non-facing part. If this phenomenon of lithium charging in the non-facing part occurs continuously, the lithium required for charging and discharging accumulates on the non-facing part, reducing the capacity of the battery, and lithium precipitation may cause safety issues.

[0077] In a secondary battery with lithium iron phosphate as the positive electrode active material, the potential difference of the negative electrode can be determined through the behavior of the open circuit voltage, and when the negative electrode is degraded due to the reduction of the available lithium due to the charging of lithium on the non-facing part not facing the positive

electrode, the potential of the negative electrode does not change over a certain number of charge/discharge cycles, so that the present disclosure can diagnose whether the secondary battery is degraded due to the charging of lithium on the non-facing part through the behavior of the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery.

[0078] The control part **130** may optionally include processors, application-specific integrated circuits (ASICs), other chipsets, logic circuits, registers, communication modems, data processing devices, and the like known in the art to execute various control logic performed by the battery management system **100** according to one aspect of the present disclosure. Further, when the control logic is implemented as software, the control part **130** may be implemented as a set of program modules. Here, the program modules may be stored in the memory part, and may be executed by a processor. For example, the control part **130** is a processor provided in the battery management system **100** according to one aspect of the present disclosure, and can provide the determined degradation status of the secondary battery **11** to a user via an output device such as a display device. The control part **130** may also provide a replacement or warning alarm of the secondary battery **11** to the user via an external notification device based on the determination result of whether the secondary battery **11** is degraded.

[0079] In a secondary battery having a positive electrode including lithium iron phosphate as the positive electrode active material, the battery management system of the present disclosure has the effect of diagnosing the degradation of the secondary battery by considering the degradation of the negative electrode as the degradation of the secondary battery from the amount of change in the open circuit voltage as the charge/discharge cycle progresses, using the feature that the potential difference of the negative electrode is represented by the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery.

[0080] FIG. 5 is a schematic diagram of a battery pack including a battery management system, according to another exemplary aspect of the present disclosure. Referring to FIG. 5, the battery management system **200** may further include a switching part **240** for turning an electrical connection between the secondary battery **11** and the charger on and off, and an interface part **250**.

[0081] The switching part **240** may include a switch **241** and a switch driver **242**. The switch **241** is installed in the path of the current for charging and discharging the secondary battery **11**. While the switch **241** is turned on, charging and discharging of the secondary battery **11** is possible. The switch **241** may be a mechanical relay that is turned on and off by the magnetic force of a coil, or it may be a semiconductor switch such as a metal oxide semiconductor field effect transistor (MOSFET). Charging and discharging of the secondary battery **11** is stopped while the switch **241** is turned off. In one aspect, the switch **241** may be turned on in response to a first control signal and turned off in response to a second control signal.

[0082] The switch driver **242**, which may be electrically connected to the switch **241** and the control part **230**, is configured to selectively output a first control signal or a second control signal to the switch **241** in response to a command from the control part **230**. The control part **230** may command the switch driver **242** to turn the switch **241** on or off when at least one of the predetermined events occurs.

[0083] The interface part **250** is configured to support wired or wireless communication between the control part **230** and an upper-level controller **2** (e.g., an electronic control unit (ECU)) of the electrical system **1**. The wired communication may be, for example, Controller Area Network (CAN) communication, and the wireless communication may be, for example, Zigbee or Bluetooth communication. Of course, the type of communication protocol is not particularly limited, as long as it supports wired or wireless communication between the control part **230** and the upper-level controller **2**.

[0084] The interface part **250** may include an output device (not shown), such as a display, speaker, or the like, to provide the results of the process regarding the degradation state of the secondary battery **11** performed by the control part **230** in a form recognizable to the user. The interface part

250 may include an input device (not shown), such as a mouse, keyboard, or the like, for receiving data input from a user.

[0085] FIG. 6 is a flowchart illustrating an exemplary method for diagnosing degradation of a secondary battery according to another exemplary aspect of the present disclosure. Referring to FIG. 6, a method for diagnosing degradation of a secondary battery according to the present disclosure includes (A) repeatedly charging and discharging the secondary battery, measuring a voltage at which the secondary battery discharges, and measuring an open circuit voltage of the secondary battery whenever the measured voltage reaches a reference discharge voltage; and (B) determining that the secondary battery is degraded if the amount of change in the open circuit voltage satisfies Condition 1 below for at least five charge/discharge cycles.

[00004] $V_{n-1} - V_n < 0.002V$ [Condition1]

[0086] (In Condition 1, V_{n-1} represents the open circuit voltage measured during the $(n-1)$.sup.th charge-discharge cycle, V_n represents the open circuit voltage measured during the n .sup.th charge/discharge cycle, and n represents a random integer)

[0087] The secondary battery to which the method of diagnosing the degradation of the secondary battery according to the present disclosure is applied is as described above.

[0088] The process (A) is a process of collecting data to diagnose whether the secondary battery is degraded. The method of diagnosing degradation according to the present invention includes: performing charge/discharge cycles of the secondary battery, measuring an open circuit voltage for each charge/discharge cycle, and collecting an open circuit voltage corresponding to a number of charge/discharge cycles.

[0089] Thus, the process (A) includes measuring an open circuit voltage of the secondary battery at the end of one charge/discharge cycle for the secondary battery. The timing of the measurement of the open circuit voltage may be during a rest period until the next charge, after the secondary battery has reached a reference discharge voltage.

[0090] The process (B) is a process for diagnosing whether a secondary battery is degraded based on the amount of change in the open circuit voltage over charge/discharge cycles collected through the process (A). Specifically, the process includes determining that the secondary battery is degraded if the condition that the difference between the open circuit voltage of the battery measured in the $n-1$.sup.th charge/discharge cycle and the voltage of the battery measured in the n .sup.th charge/discharge cycle is less than 0.002 V is satisfied for five charge/discharge cycles.

[0091] Referring to FIG. 6, the process (A) includes measuring the voltage of the secondary battery and the open circuit voltage while repeatedly charging and discharging the secondary battery.

[0092] Repeated charging and discharging of a secondary battery means charging a secondary battery in a discharged state and discharging a secondary battery in a charged state, setting this as a single charge/discharge cycle, and repeating such charge/discharge cycle several times.

[0093] In one charge/discharge cycle, the voltage of the secondary battery can be measured while charging the secondary battery and then discharging the secondary battery from the charged state. The voltage measurement of the secondary battery may be performed at regular temporal intervals.

[0094] While monitoring whether the measured voltage of the secondary battery reaches the reference discharge voltage, a discharge and measuring the voltage of the secondary battery until the voltage measurement of the secondary battery reaches the reference discharge voltage is performed.

[0095] If the voltage measurement reaches the reference discharge voltage, the discharge of the secondary battery is terminated, allowing the secondary battery to rest. Resting means to stop supplying current to the secondary battery for charging and discharging. After this discharge, the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery is measured at rest.

[0096] In an exemplary aspect, the charging and discharging method in the process (A) may include a charging and discharging method applicable to the secondary battery, and as non-limited examples, a constant current (CC) method, a constant voltage (CV) method, a constant power (CP)

method, a combined CC-CV method, and a CP-CV method may be listed, and an appropriate charging and discharging method may be selected according to the type of secondary battery. For example, a CP charging and discharging method can be selected for a secondary battery for ESS. The charge and discharge rate (C-rate, CP-rate) is also not specifically limited, and a suitable range of charge and discharge rates can be selected by considering the charge and discharge characteristics of the electrode.

[0097] As shown in FIG. 4, as the charge/discharge cycle of the secondary battery progresses, the change in the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery gradually decreases, and eventually the change in open circuit voltage becomes less than 0.002V.

[0098] In determining whether a secondary battery has degraded, based on the amount of change in the open circuit voltage, and specifically, if the condition that the amount of change between the open circuit voltage of the battery measured in the $n-1$ st charge/discharge cycle and the open circuit voltage of the battery measured in the n th charge/discharge cycle is less than 0.002V is satisfied for at least five charge/discharge cycles, the present invention determines the secondary battery as degraded.

[0099] The present invention will now be described in more detail by way of example. However, the following examples are intended to illustrate the invention and are not intended to limit the scope of the invention.

Example

[0100] (The process of collecting the open circuit voltage for each charge/discharge cycle of a secondary battery)

[0101] A battery cell provided with a negative electrode of 100% synthetic graphite as the negative electrode active material and a positive electrode of 100% LiFePO_4 as the positive electrode active material was prepared. The battery cell was charged to 3.65V at a rate of 1CP-rate and discharged to 2.5V at a rate of 1CP-rate. During the discharge of the battery cell, the voltage of the battery cell was monitored, and the discharge was terminated when the voltage of the battery cell was 2.5V. Five seconds after the end of the discharge, the open circuit voltage of the battery cell was measured and the result was stored as $V_{\text{sub.1}}$.

[0102] Then, charge and discharge were repeated n times in the same way as above, but each open circuit voltage measured in each charge/discharge cycle was stored as $V_{\text{sub.2}}$, $V_{\text{sub.3}}$ $V_{\text{sub.n}}$.

[0103] (The process of determining whether a secondary battery is degraded)

[0104] While repeatedly charging and discharging the battery cell, the difference between the open circuit voltage $V_{\text{sub.n-1}}$ measured in the previous charge/discharge cycle and the open circuit voltage $V_{\text{sub.n}}$ measured in the current charge/discharge cycle was calculated, and when the number of times the difference in the open circuit voltage was less than 0.002 V accumulated five times, the charging and discharging of the battery cell was terminated, and the battery cell was determined to be degraded.

Experimental Example 1: Identifying Lithium on a Non-Facing Part of the Negative Electrode not Facing the Positive Electrode

[0105] In a battery cell determined to be degraded according to the above example, the negative electrode was obtained by opening the battery case and disassembling the electrode assembly housed therein. Upon observation of the negative electrode, it was found that lithium was precipitated on the non-facing part. Based on these results, it appears that the degradation diagnosis method according to the present invention can diagnose the accumulation of lithium at the area of the negative electrode not facing the positive electrode.

Experimental Example 2: Confirming Capacity Retention Rate

[0106] For the battery cell of the example, the discharge capacity 1 was measured in the first charge/discharge cycle. The discharge capacity 2 of the battery cell was measured in the charge/discharge cycle in which the battery cell was determined to be degraded according to the

example. Then, the capacity retention rate was calculated according to Equation 1 below.

[00005] $(\text{dischargecapacity2} \times 100) / \text{dischargecapacity1}$ Equation1

[0107] The calculated capacity retention rate was 83%. Generally, a secondary battery with a capacity retention rate of 80% is considered to be degraded, and the degradation diagnosis method according to the present invention is analyzed to be effective for the degradation diagnosis of a secondary battery having lithium iron phosphate as the positive electrode active material.

[0108] The examples of the present invention described above are not only implemented through the battery management system **100** and the method, but may also be implemented through a program that implements a function corresponding to the configuration of an aspect of the present invention or a recording medium on which the program is recorded, and such implementation can be easily implemented by an expert in the technical field to which the present invention belongs from the description of the aspects described above.

[0109] Although the present invention has been described above by way of limited aspects and drawings, the present invention is not limited thereby, and various modifications and variations may be made by one having ordinary knowledge in the technical field to which the present invention belongs, within the equitable scope of the technical idea of the present invention and the claims of the patent set forth below.

[0110] Furthermore, the present disclosure described above is not limited by the foregoing aspects and accompanying drawings, as various substitutions, modifications, and changes can be made without departing from the technical ideas of the present disclosure by one of ordinary skill in the art to which the present disclosure belongs, and all or portions of each aspect can be optionally combined so that various variations can be made.

Claims

1. A battery management system for diagnosing the degradation of a secondary battery equipped with a positive electrode including lithium iron phosphate as a positive electrode active material, comprising: a sensing part configured to measure the voltage and open circuit voltage of a secondary battery; a memory part configured to store the open circuit voltage measured by the sensing part; and a control part configured to determine that the secondary battery is degraded when an amount of change in the open circuit voltage due to charge/discharge cycles of the secondary battery satisfies Condition 1 for at least five charge/discharge cycles:

$V_{n-1} - V_n < 0.002V$, [Condition1] wherein V_{n-1} represents the open circuit voltage measured during the (n-1).sup.th charge-discharge cycle, V_n represents the open circuit voltage measured during the n.sup.th charge/discharge cycle, and n is an integer.)

2. The battery management system of claim 1, wherein the sensing part is configured to measure the discharge voltage of the secondary battery during discharge and to measure the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery when the measured discharge voltage reaches a reference discharge voltage.

3. The battery management system of claim 2, wherein the sensing part is configured to measure the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery during a rest period after the measured discharge voltage reaches the reference discharge voltage.

4. The battery management system of claim 1, wherein the sensing part is configured to measure the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery at an end of a charge/discharge cycle.

5. The battery management system of claim 1, further comprising a switching part that turns the electrical connection between the secondary battery and a charger on or off.

6. A battery pack comprising: a battery management system according to claim 1; and a plurality of secondary batteries.

7. The battery pack of claim 6, wherein each secondary battery includes a negative electrode

having negative electrode active material, the negative electrode active material comprising from 50 to 100% of a graphite-based negative electrode active material.

8. A method for diagnosing the degradation of a secondary battery equipped with a positive electrode including lithium iron phosphate as a positive electrode active material, comprising: (A) repeatedly charging and discharging a secondary battery, while measuring the discharge voltage when the secondary battery discharges and measuring the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery when the measured discharge voltage reaches a reference discharge voltage; and (B) determining that the secondary battery is degraded when the change in open circuit voltage satisfies Condition 1 for at least five charge/discharge cycles: $V_{n-1} - V_n < 0.002V$, [Condition1] (wherein V_{n-1} represents the open circuit voltage measured during the (n-1).sup.th charge-discharge cycle, V_n represents the open circuit voltage measured during the n.sup.th charge/discharge cycle, and n is an integer.)

9. The method for diagnosing the degradation of a secondary battery of claim 8, wherein the process (A) includes measuring the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery during a rest period after the measured discharge voltage reaches the reference discharge voltage.

10. The method for diagnosing the degradation of a secondary battery of claim 8, wherein the process (A) includes measuring the open circuit voltage of the secondary battery at an end of a charge/discharge cycle.

11. The method for diagnosing the degradation of a secondary battery of claim 8, wherein the secondary battery includes 50 to 100% graphite-based negative electrode active material as negative electrode active material.
